

Thomas Ross

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EXPERIENCE

Vendr, Boston, MA

December 2025 — Present

Full-Stack Software Engineer

- Built a turn-by-turn SaaS negotiation simulator for SMEs, enabling sandboxed testing of agent behavior, prompt changes, eval suites, and negotiation data structures.
- Developed an LLM-driven pipeline to normalize Vendr's historic data (emails, Slack, Intercom, contract PDFs) across thousands of negotiations into structured training/testing data, classifying interactions against 23 negotiation-action types.
- Use DSPy to optimize agent prompts against evals derived from historic deals, closing the loop between real negotiation outcomes and prompt quality.
- Contribute to the core agent harness that runs autonomous SaaS negotiations end-to-end.

BrightBook, Boston, MA

January 2024 — September 2025

Founder and CEO

- Designed and shipped full-stack AI lesson-planning workflows for lesson generation, differentiation, classroom materials, and teacher editing, translating educator feedback into rapid product iterations.
- Launched pilot across Boston Public Schools, analyzing teacher usage data and qualitative feedback to improve retention, lesson quality, and classroom fit.
- Secured \$20K+ in non-dilutive funding, won 2nd Place out of 160 startups in BU's 2025 New Venture Competition, participated in BU's 2025 Summer Accelerator.

Stumped, Port Chester, NY

January 2019 — May 2022

Co-Founder and Lead Engineer

- Architected and developed a full-stack web app supporting real-time classroom gameplay, teacher dashboards, and student participation flows; Awarded NYS School Boards Association Champions of Change.
- Scaled platform to 700+ students and 100 teachers, incorporating classroom feedback into product design and feature development; participated in NYU's 2020 Spring Startup Accelerator.

EDUCATION

Boston University Questrom School of Business, Boston, MA

August 2021 — January 2025

Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, cum laude

SKILLS

AI/LLMs: LLM Agents, Evals, DSPy, RAG, Schema Complexity & Grammar, Prompt Optimization, Vector Search

Full-Stack: TypeScript, Python, React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, API Design, Authentication, Real-Time Systems

Data/Infra: SQL, ETL Pipelines, Training Data Pipelines, AWS, Firebase, CI/CD

Product: AI Product Development, Customer Discovery, Pilot Programs, Rapid Prototyping